

ISTQB FOUNDATION MASTERCLASS

Syllabus Mind Maps

Text mind maps for each syllabus chapter — central topic, branches and sub-branches.

How to Read These Mind Maps

Each chapter is a central topic. Top-level bullets are the main branches; indented bullets are sub-branches. Redraw each map on blank paper from memory — the act of rebuilding the structure is what fixes the syllabus in your mind.

Chapter 1 — Fundamentals of Testing

- Central topic: What testing is and why we do it.
 1. What is testing? — objectives, testing vs debugging
 2. Why is testing necessary? — contribution to success, quality assurance vs quality control, errors/defects/failures/root causes
 3. Seven testing principles — presence not absence, exhaustive impossible, early testing, clustering, pesticide paradox, context dependent, absence-of-errors fallacy
 4. Test activities — the test process, test work products, traceability
 5. Essential skills — tester mindset, whole-team approach, independence of testing

Chapter 2 — Testing Throughout the SDLC

- Central topic: How testing fits into software development.
 1. SDLC models — sequential (waterfall, V-model), iterative/incremental, Agile; good testing practices
 2. Test levels — Component, Component integration, System, System integration, Acceptance
 3. Test types — functional, non-functional, black-box, white-box
 4. Confirmation and regression testing — after each change
 5. Maintenance testing — triggers and impact analysis

Chapter 3 — Static Testing

- Central topic: Examining work products without running them.
 1. Static testing basics — work products examinable, value, static vs dynamic testing
 2. Feedback and review process — benefits of early feedback, review activities, roles (manager, author, moderator, scribe, reviewer, leader)

3. Review types — informal, walkthrough, technical review, inspection
4. Success factors — for the review and for the people involved

Chapter 4 — Test Analysis and Design (Test Techniques)

- Central topic: Deriving good test cases systematically.
 1. Categories of techniques — black-box, white-box, experience-based
 2. Black-box techniques — equivalence partitioning, boundary value analysis, decision table testing, state transition testing
 3. White-box techniques — statement testing and coverage, branch testing and coverage
 4. Experience-based techniques — error guessing, exploratory testing, checklist-based testing
 5. Collaboration-based approaches — acceptance criteria, acceptance test-driven development (ATDD)

Chapter 5 — Managing the Test Activities

- Central topic: Planning, estimating and controlling testing.
 1. Test planning — purpose and content, tester contribution, entry and exit criteria, estimation techniques, test case prioritisation, test pyramid, testing quadrants
 2. Risk management — definition of risk, product vs project risk, risk-based testing, risk analysis and control
 3. Test monitoring, control and completion — metrics, test reports, communication of test status
 4. Configuration management — supporting testing
 5. Defect management — the defect workflow and defect report contents

Chapter 6 — Test Tools

- Central topic: Supporting testing with tooling.
 1. Tool support for testing — what tools can do across the test process
 2. Benefits and risks of automation — repeatability and speed vs maintenance cost and over-reliance

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Draw each map from memory on a single sheet of paper. If a branch is missing when you compare against this sheet, that gap is exactly what the exam is most likely to catch you on.